

Chapter

Gandhian Era and The Struggle for Independence

1. The Rowlatt Act was called the Black Act because the Indians:

- (a) Could not possess any arms
- (b) Could not export any goods
- (c) Could be arrested without a warrant
- (d) Could be sent overseas on duty

MAIN 2024

2. Mention any two causes of the Quit India Movement.

MAIN 2024

3. The famous Nagpur Session of the Indian National Congress in 1920 adopted a resolution to launch Non-Cooperation Movement. In this context, answer the following questions:

- (i) Reasons or circumstances for launching the Non-Cooperation Movement.**
- (ii) Which Mass Struggle was launched by Gandhi on non-violent lines in 1920? Explain in brief the programmes of such a Campaign.**
- (iii) Reason for the withdrawal of the Movement.**
- (iv) Importance of the Movement.**
- (v) What were the objectives which the movement sought to achieve ?**

MAIN 2024

4. Which tragic incident prompted Gandhiji to launch the Non-Cooperation Movement?

COMP 2024

5. Which provision of the Rowlatt Act aroused widespread popular indignation?

SQP 2023

6. Mention any two recommendations of the Simon Commission.

SQP 2023

7. People protested against the _____ because it had seven British members and no Indian representation.

- (a) Simon Commission
- (b) Lucknow Pact
- (c) Ilbert Bill
- (d) Cabinet Mission

MAIN 2023

8. The main objective of the Assertive Nationalists was _____ .

- (a) Constitutional agitation
- (b) Peaceful protests
- (c) Purna Swaraj
- (d) Self-government under British Rule

MAIN 2023

9. _____ was one of the causes of the Quit India Movement.

- (a) Failure of the Second Round Table Conference
- (b) Rowlatt Act
- (c) Mountbatten Plan
- (d) Failure of the Cripps Mission

MAIN 2023

10. Name two of the leading lights (main leaders) of the Non-Cooperation Movement of 1920.

MAIN 2023

11. Look at the picture given below and answer the following questions:



(i) Name the march being led by Gandhiji in the above picture. Which movement did this march launch?

(ii) What were the three causes of the Non-Cooperation Movement? Name the incident which led to the suspension of this movement.

(iii) Mahatma Gandhi and Lord Irwin signed a pact in 1931. Mention any two conditions that the Congress agreed to and two conditions that the British Government agreed to according to this pact.

MAIN 2023

12. What was the primary objective of the Quit India Movement?

- (a) To demand full independence from Britain
- (b) To organize non-violent protests
- (c) To promote a constitutional solution for self-rule
- (d) To demand the abolition of the salt tax

SQP 2022

13. What was the outcome of the Chauri Chaura incident?

- (a) Gandhi called for a complete boycott of British goods
- (b) The Non-Cooperation Movement was suspended
- (c) The movement gained momentum
- (d) Indian National Congress became more radical

SQP 2022

14. Name any two movements launched by Gandhiji against British rule in India.

MAIN 2021

15. Where was the Quit India Resolution passed?

- (a) Lucknow
- (b) Bombay
- (c) Lahore
- (d) Kolkata

COMP 2021

Solution

1.

Ans: (c) Could be arrested without a warrant

Explanation:

The **Rowlatt Act (1919)** was called the **Black Act** because it allowed the British government to **arrest and detain Indians without a warrant or trial**.

It suspended civil liberties and gave the authorities sweeping powers, leading to widespread anger and protests.

Thus, the correct option is (c).

2.

Ans:

(i) Failure of the Cripps Mission:

The British proposal of **limited self-government** offered by the Cripps Mission was rejected by Indian leaders, causing disappointment and increasing demands for complete independence.

(ii) Impact of World War II:

India was **dragged into World War II without being consulted**, which angered the people and strengthened the call for the British to quit India.

3.

Ans:

(i) Reasons for launching the Non-Cooperation Movement:

(a) Failure of the Montague-Chelmsford Reforms: The reforms were viewed as inadequate and disappointing, giving Indians **very little control** over administration.

(b) Rowlatt Act: The Act allowed the British to **arrest and detain people without trial**, leading to widespread anger. It was called the **Black Act**.

(c) Jallianwala Bagh Massacre: The brutal firing on peaceful protesters at Jallianwala Bagh shocked the country and increased **anti-British sentiment**.

(d) Khilafat Issue: The ill-treatment of Turkey after World War I angered Indian Muslims, and leaders like Gandhi supported the **Khilafat Movement** to show solidarity.

(ii) Mass struggle launched by Gandhi in 1920 and its programmes:

The mass struggle launched was the **Non-Cooperation Movement**, based on **non-violence and non-cooperation**.

Programmes included:

1. **Boycott of British goods and institutions:** Refusal to use British schools, courts, and imported goods.
2. **Promotion of Swadeshi and Khadi:** Encouraging people to use **local products** and wear khadi.
3. **Surrender of titles and honours:** Indians renounced British titles; Gandhi returned the title of **Kaiser-i-Hind**.
4. **Resignation from government posts:** To weaken British authority.
5. **Non-payment of taxes (in some regions):** To challenge British economic control.
6. **Peaceful demonstrations:** Meetings, marches, and prayers to spread awareness of self-rule.

(iii) Reason for the withdrawal of the Movement:

Gandhi called off the movement after the **Chauri Chaura incident (1922)**, where protesters turned violent and **killed policemen**.

Gandhi felt that the people had not yet understood non-violence and therefore **suspended the movement**.

(iv) Importance of the Movement:

(a) Spread of nationalism: The movement brought **ordinary people** into the struggle, not just educated elites.

(b) Hindu-Muslim unity: It created a sense of **unity among different communities**.

(c) Impact on Congress: It led Congress to adopt **Satyagraha and mass movements** as strategies in future struggles.

(v) Objectives achieved by the movement:

(a) Protest against injustice: It aimed to oppose British actions like the **Jallianwala Bagh massacre** and repressive laws.

(b) Support for Khilafat: It worked to restore the **status of the Sultan of Turkey**.

(c) Attainment of Swaraj: The movement aimed to achieve **self-rule (Swaraj)** through peaceful mass action.

4.

Ans: The **Jallianwala Bagh Tragedy (1919)** prompted Gandhiji to launch the **Non-Cooperation Movement**.

5.

Ans: The provision of "**No Dalil, No Vakil, No Appeal**"—meaning **no pleading, no lawyer, and no appeal**—aroused widespread popular indignation under the Rowlatt Act.

6.

Ans:

(i) The Provincial Legislative Councils should be enlarged and given more representatives.

(ii) Communal representation should continue, ensuring separate representation for different communities.

7.

Ans: (a) Simon Commission

Explanation:

People protested against the **Simon Commission (1928)** because it had **seven British members and no Indian representation**, which was seen as an insult to Indian self-government.

Thus, the correct option is **(a)**.

8.

Ans: (c) Purna Swaraj

Explanation:

The main objective of the **Assertive Nationalists** was to achieve **Purna Swaraj (complete independence)** from British rule, unlike the Early Nationalists who demanded only gradual reforms.

Thus, the correct option is **(c)**.

9.

Ans: (d) Failure of the Cripps Mission

Explanation:

The **failure of the Cripps Mission (1942)** was one of the major causes of the Quit India Movement, as the British offer of limited self-government was rejected and led to widespread disappointment and anger.

Thus, the correct option is **(d)**.

10.

Ans: Two leading lights of the Non-Cooperation Movement (1920) were:

C. R. Das and Rajendra Prasad.

11.

Ans:

(i) The march shown in the picture is the **Dandi March (Salt March) of 1930**, led by Gandhiji.

It marked the beginning of the **Civil Disobedience Movement**, which protested against the salt tax and British monopoly over salt.

(ii) Three causes of the Non-Cooperation Movement were:

- 1. Jallianwala Bagh Massacre:** The brutal killing of peaceful protesters in Amritsar in 1919 created nationwide anger against British rule.
- 2. Rowlatt Act:** This repressive Act allowed imprisonment without trial, leading to widespread protests.
- 3. Khilafat Movement:** Gandhiji supported Indian Muslims protesting against British treatment of the Ottoman Caliph, which helped unite Hindus and Muslims.

The movement was **suspended due to the Chauri Chaura incident (1922)**, where violent clashes led to burning of a police station and deaths of policemen.

(iii) Under the Gandhi-Irwin Pact (1931):

Congress agreed to:

(a) Suspend the Civil Disobedience Movement, stopping all protests and boycotts.

(b) Participate in the Second Round Table Conference in London to discuss constitutional changes.

The British Government agreed to:

(a) Release non-violent political prisoners, freeing those arrested during the movement.

(b) Permit salt production, allowing Indians to make salt along the coast for personal use.

12.

Ans: (a) To demand full independence from Britain

Explanation:

The **primary objective of the Quit India Movement (1942)** was to demand **complete independence and an immediate end to British rule in India**, symbolised by the call "Do or Die."

Thus, the correct option is **(a)**.

13.

Ans: (b) The Non-Cooperation Movement was suspended

Explanation:

The **Chauri Chaura incident (1922)**, in which a violent clash led to the burning of a police station and the death of policemen, prompted **Gandhiji to suspend the Non-Cooperation Movement**, as he did not want violence to be associated with the freedom struggle.

Thus, the correct option is **(b)**.

14.

Ans: Two movements launched by Gandhiji against British rule in India were:

Non-Cooperation Movement and Civil Disobedience Movement.

15.

Ans: (b) Bombay

Explanation:

The **Quit India Resolution** was passed at the **Bombay session of the Indian National Congress in August 1942**, launching the Quit India Movement.

Thus, the correct option is **(b)**.